



Setting up Memories of Murder

An analysis of Bong Joon-ho's magnum opus; themes, setups and character development. <http://digit.in/nov20-39>



Perfect Blue main theme

The infamous eerie OST from one of the most terrifying anime movies out there. <http://digit.in/nov20-40>

mother! might not necessarily be a film suited to everyone's taste (owing to an inconclusive plot), there are definitely elements in it that are appreciable. The performances are great, the cinematography is beautiful and the symbolism is eyebrow-raising. Overall, it is an absolutely relentless experience!



MEMORIES OF MURDER (2003)

Memories of Murder is a dark and grim, murder mystery film from Oscar-Winning, South Korean director Bong

Joon-ho. Inspired by true events, the film follows the story of three police detectives, as they take on a terrifying case, that would eventually be known as the infamous "Hwanseong Serial Murders". Often hailed as Korea's first set of serial killings in history, the film takes you on a twisted, spine-chilling investigative journey, in a rural town where numerous women were found brutally raped and murdered. Adding onto the tense atmosphere, this critically-acclaimed masterpiece also exhibits comedic elements to keep you engaged. If you like a serving of black comedy and slapstick humour with your disturbing film choices, you should give this a try.



BURNING (2018)

Burning is a South Korean psychological drama-thriller from director Lee Chang-dong. The plot mainly revolves around a young delivery

guy, Jong-su, who runs into one of his childhood friends, who dreams of travelling to Africa. Upon return, she introduces him to a mysterious young man named Ben, who loves talking about his bizarrely unusual hobby. The tone of this film is extremely unsettling and chilling. It is riddled with tons of subliminal messages and metaphorical

dialogues, that should easily give away the ending, provided you devote 00 percent of your attention to it. Its cinematography is strikingly gorgeous and ominous, while the performances are nothing short of hauntingly outstanding. If you enjoyed Bong Joon-ho's Oscar-Winning Parasite, it is highly recommended that you check this one out as well!



DONNIE DARKO (2001)

Director Richard Kelly's Donnie Darko sees a really young Jake Gyllenhaal befriending a six-foot-tall, imaginary bunny rabbit, after

having narrowly escaped a bizarre accident. This so-called "friend", then manipulates him to commit a series of heinous crimes, endangering the lives of people around him. The film sheds light on mental illness (schizophrenia), hallucinations, teenage angst, an imminent apocalypse and even time travel, in a quite artistic and somewhat confusing manner. Confusing, in a good sense.



GONE GIRL (2014)

Based on the 2012 novel of the same name, Gone Girl is the second film in this list from director David Fincher. The story follows the

shenanigans of a picture-perfect, married couple - Nick and Amy. Following the mysterious disappearance of Amy, one fine morning, her husband is tagged as primary suspect by the police and media. The film does a fantastic job of toying with your mind, by getting you to side with either characters from time to time. Watching the film, you will go through various motions involving family-drama, suspense, dark revelations and manipulative tactics. So much so, that by the end of it, you will definitely grow to either love or despise the characters on a much deeper, personal level.



PERFECT BLUE (1997)

Satoshi Kon's Perfect Blue is a Japanese animated (anime) psychological horror-thriller that explores the idea of duality and

psychosis. The story follows a retired pop singer turned actress, Mima, who upon shedding her "good girl" image, shakes up her sense of reality. The film sheds light on struggles with career advancements, self-identity, stalker issues and maintaining one's sanity. The genius of Satoshi manages to seamlessly blur the line between reality and fantasy, creating a terrifying and unsettling experience that lingers with you for quite some time. Also, the animation is top-notch and feels realistic, while the score is grim and looming, which compliments the fear aspect really well. It is a masterpiece!



PSYCHO (1960)

Alfred Hitchcock's Psycho is a pure classic. One of the pioneers for a long-line of psychological horror/thriller films in the years to come. The

plot follows Marion, a young woman, who disappears after stealing a large sum of money from her employer. All tired and exhausted from the run, she stumbles upon the notorious Bates Motel, where everything seems fine, until she decides to take a shower. Yep, that same infamous shower scene that has been referred to multiple times, and beaten to the death, throughout the history of cinema. The film has got an engaging script, haunting cinematography, and a chilling soundtrack that amplifies the suspense and the horrifying aspects. Sure, some of the performances might seem corny, but then again, it is a trend that most older films suffer from anyway. 